

the risk of exploitation caused by discovery of your password. Ensure that you change your password every 3 months.

Your firewall keeps your system safe and secure. Keep it turned on always. This helps protect your system from hackers who might be interested in stealing data and crashing your system. Single computers especially require strong firewalls. The firewall software can be easily purchased for individual systems and for multiple networked systems, hardware routers double up as firewalls. And make sure that your firewall or antivirus software is updated and equipped to prevent malicious attacks on your computer. The antivirus scan must be done regularly and should come with enough capacity to remove the malware, if any.

Viruses can infect any computer without the user's knowledge. Since most antivirus software can update automatically, the risk is considerably reduced with the help of a strong antivirus. Most computers come along with some form of antivirus already installed. This just reiterates the importance of having a dynamic antivirus installed in your system. If you don't have it yet, do it now. NOW.

Don't fall for phishing

One of the most common forms of cybercrime, phishing is where criminals send fake email to the user, pretending to be a bank or a credit card

provider. Phishing is on the rise and is perhaps the largest form of identity theft in the internet. Luckily, the banks are now aware and are sending emails to their customers, warning them of phishing attacks and creating awareness among the general public.

Phishing approaches unwary users, most often persuading them to part with their confidential

information, including details like credit card PIN and online banking passwords. These happen on websites that are cleverly deceptive and are replicas of original websites of banks. Sadly, phishing is now a global menace,

